

SCHOOLS OF BUDDHISM

COMMON BUDDHIST FOUNDATION → PRACTICAL AND DOCTRINAL MIDDLE → TWELVE-LINKED DEPENDENT ORIGATION → MOMENTARINESS AND NO-SELF → ACTION AND MORAL CONSEQUENCE → ABHIDHARMA SCHOOL FORK

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE Pending user review source generation g13 repaired in place; prior artifacts unchanged outside the scoped current generation

CORE BEFORE EXTRA prior artefacts unchanged exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 COMMON BUDDHIST FOUNDATION

COMMON BUDDHIST FOUNDATION COMMON THERAPEUTIC CORE SUFFERING (DUHKHA) ORIGIN (TRŚNĀ/AVIDYĀ) CESSATION (NIRVĀNA) EIGHTFOLD PATH THREE MARKS SUFFERING (DUHKHA) ANĀTMAN DEPENDENT ORIGATION SUPPLIES THE MIDDLE PATH (MADHYAMĀ PRATIPAD) NEITHER ETERNAL SUBSTANCE NOR CAUSELESS ANNIHILATION LATER SCHOOLS DISAGREE

COMMON THERAPEUTIC CORE suffering (duḥkha) → origin (tr̥ṣṇā/avidyā) → cessation (nirvāna) → eightfold path three

suffering (duḥkha)

→

anātmān dependent origination supplies the Middle Path (madhyamā pratipad)

→

neither eternal substance nor causeless annihilation later schools disagree about what exists and how it

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• COMMON THERAPEUTIC CORE suffering (duḥkha) → origin (tr̥ṣṇā/avidyā) → cessation (nirvāna) → eightfold path three marks: anitya

• suffering (duḥkha)

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• anātmān dependent origination supplies the Middle Path (madhyamā pratipad)

• neither eternal substance nor causeless annihilation later schools disagree about what exists and how it is known, not

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• about the need to end ignorance and craving.

• COMMON THERAPEUTIC CORE suffering (duḥkha) → origin (tr̥ṣṇā/avidyā) → cessation (nirvāna) → eightfold path three marks: anitya

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Buddhist schools share dependent origination and no-self but disagree over external objects, consciousness and ultimate truth; comparison must therefore preserve both their common therapeutic framework and their distinct ontologies.

01

STAGE 01 PRACTICAL AND DOCTRINAL MIDDLE PATH

PRACTICAL AND DOCTRINAL MIDDLE PATH MIDDLE PATH (MADHYAMĀ PRATIPAD; PALI) MAJJIHĪMĀ PATIPADĀ PRACTICAL EXTREMES SENSUAL INDULGENCE X SELF-MORTIFICATION POSITIVE ROUTE NOBLE EIGHTFOLD PATH (ĀRYAŚTAṄGAMĀRGA) WISDOM + ETHICAL DISCIPLINE + ETERNALISM X ANNIHILATIONISM DEPENDENT ORIGATION PRESERVES CONDITIONED CONTINUITY WITHOUT FOUR NOBLE TRUTHS

MIDDLE PATH (MADHYAMĀ PRATIPAD)

→

PALI: MAJJIHĪMĀ PATIPADĀ practical extremes: sensual indulgence X self-mortification positive route → Noble Eightfold Path

→

Four Noble Truths → cause → cessation → path → liberation

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• MIDDLE PATH (MADHYAMĀ PRATIPAD)

• PALI: MAJJIHĪMĀ PATIPADĀ practical extremes: sensual indulgence X self-mortification positive route → Noble Eightfold Path (āryaśtaṅgamārga) wisdom +

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• Four Noble Truths → cause → cessation → path → liberation

• MIDDLE PATH (MADHYAMĀ PRATIPAD)

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• PALI: MAJJIHĪMĀ PATIPADĀ practical extremes: sensual indulgence X self-mortification positive route → Noble Eightfold Path (āryaśtaṅgamārga) wisdom +

• Four Noble Truths → cause → cessation → path → liberation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Final verdict: Buddhist philosophy replaces substantial identity with dependent continuity, but its success depends on explaining how causal efficacy, knowledge and liberation remain coherent without a permanent self or intrinsic essence.

02

STAGE 02 TWELVE-LINKED DEPENDENT ORIGATION

TWELVE-LINKED DEPENDENT ORIGATION IGNORANCE (AVIDYĀ) IGNORANCE CONDITIONS FORMATIONS: CRAVING AND GRASPING RENEW BECOMING WHEN THIS IS, THAT COMES TO BE, WITH CESSATION END IGNORANCE (AVIDYĀ)/TRŚNĀ BREAK APPROPRIATION END REBIRTH-DUHKHA.

Ignorance (avidyā) → saṃsāra → vijñāna → nāma-rūpa → ṣaḍāyatana → sparśa

vedanā → tr̥ṣṇā → upādāna → bhava → jāti → jarā-marana

→

IGNORANCE conditions formations; craving and grasping renew becoming

→

"When this is, that comes to be"

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• Ignorance (avidyā) → saṃsāra → vijñāna → nāma-rūpa → ṣaḍāyatana → sparśa

• vedanā → tr̥ṣṇā → upādāna → bhava → jāti → jarā-marana

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• IGNORANCE conditions formations; craving and grasping renew becoming

• "When this is, that comes to be"

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• with cessation of this, that ceases" reverse order: end ignorance (avidyā)/tr̥ṣṇā → break appropriation → end rebirth-duḥkha.

• Ignorance (avidyā) → saṃsāra → vijñāna → nāma-rūpa → ṣaḍāyatana → sparśa

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Dependent origination explains arising through conditions and therefore avoids both eternal substances and causeless annihilation.

03

STAGE 03 MOMENTARINESS AND NO-SELF

MOMENTARINESS AND NO-SELF DEPENDENT ORIGATION (PRATITYASAMUTPĀDA) CONDITIONED THINGS ARISE AND PERISH (KṢANIKĀVĀDA) CAUSAL EFFICACY BELONGS TO THE MOMENT; NO UNCHANGED PERSON ANALYSIS FIVE AGGREGATES (SKANDHAS) RŪPA VIJÑĀNA NONE IS PERMANENT, INDEPENDENT OR "MINE" NO PERMANENT SELF (NAIRĀTMYAVĀDA) CONTINUITY

DEPENDENT ORIGATION (pratityasamutpāda) → conditioned things arise and perish → MOMENTARINESS

(kṣaṇikavāda) causal efficacy belongs to the moment; no unchanged bearer is required

→

PERSON ANALYSIS → five aggregates (skandhas) rūpa

→

vijñāna none is permanent, independent or "mine" → NO PERMANENT SELF (nairātmyavāda) continuity = causal

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• DEPENDENT ORIGATION (pratityasamutpāda) → conditioned things arise and perish → MOMENTARINESS

• (kṣanikavāda) causal efficacy belongs to the moment; no unchanged bearer is required

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• PERSON ANALYSIS → five aggregates (skandhas) rūpa

• vijñāna none is permanent, independent or "mine" → NO PERMANENT SELF (nairātmyavāda) continuity = causal series, like flame-to-flame

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• Identity is neither strict sameness nor total unrelatedness.

• DEPENDENT ORIGATION (pratityasamutpāda) → conditioned things arise and perish → MOMENTARINESS

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: No permanent self (nairātmyavāda) (no-self doctrine) denies an eternal enduring self (ātman) (self) and explains the person as a dependently ordered continuum of five aggregates (skandhas) (aggregates), preserving conventional identity without a permanent substance.

04

STAGE 04 ACTION AND MORAL CONSEQUENCE (KARMA), MEMORY AND CESSATION OF CONDITIONED SUFFERING (NIRVĀṆA)

ACTION AND MORAL CONSEQUENCE (KARMA), MEMORY AND CESSATION OF NO ENDURING SELF (ĀTMAN), YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY INTENTION AT CONDITIONS STREAM FRUIT AT T2 MEMORY LATER COGNITION CAUSALLY CONDITIONED BY EARLIER EXPERIENCE REBIRTH ONE PSYCHO-PHYSICAL SERIES CONDITIONS ANOTHER, WITHOUT SOUL-TRANSMIGRATION OBJECTION IF AGENT PERISHES, ANOTHER RECEIVES RESULT REPLY SUCCESSOR IS NEITHER IDENTICAL NOR WHOLLY DIFFERENT; CAUSAL APPROPRIATION

NO ENDURING SELF (ātmān), YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY intention at t1 → conditions stream → fruit

→

causal appropriation connects cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāna) = cessation of greed, hatred and delusion

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• NO ENDURING SELF (ātmān), YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY intention at t1 → conditions stream → fruit at t2 memory

• causal appropriation connects cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāna) = cessation of greed, hatred and delusion, not destruction of

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• NO ENDURING SELF (ātmān), YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY intention at t1 → conditions stream → fruit at t2 memory

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IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• NO ENDURING SELF (ātmān), YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY intention at t1 → conditions stream → fruit at t2 memory

• causal appropriation connects cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāna) = cessation of greed, hatred and delusion, not destruction of

MECHANISM / VERDICT — NO ENDURING SELF (ātmān), YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY intention at t1 → conditions stream → fruit at t2 memory = later cognition causally conditioned by earlier experience rebirth = one psycho-physical series conditions another, without soul-transmigration objection: if agent perishes, another receives result reply: successor is neither identical nor wholly different; causal appropriation connects cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāna) = cessation of greed, hatred and delusion, not destruction of a substance-self.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: if agent perishes, another receives result reply: successor is neither identical nor wholly different; causal appropriation connects cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāna) = cessation of greed, hatred and delusion, not destruction of a substance-self.

05

STAGE 05 ABHIDHARMA SCHOOL FORK

ABHIDHARMA SCHOOL FORK BUDDHIST REALITY KNOWLEDGE DEBATE HINAYĀNA REALISTS MAHĀYĀNA VAIBHĀṢIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA YOGĀCĀRA MĀDHYAMIKA EXTERNAL EXTERNAL OBJECTS COGNITION EMPTINESS SCHOOL LABELS MARK EPISTEMIC/ONTOLOGICAL POSITIONS, NOT FOUR PATHS TO

BUDDHIST REALITY / KNOWLEDGE DEBATE

HINAYĀNA REALISTS MAHĀYĀNA

→

Vaibhāṣika Sautrāntika Yogācāra Mādhyamika external external objects cognition emptiness of dharmas inferred from ideas only

→

(svabhāva) directly and causal effects perceived

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• BUDDHIST REALITY / KNOWLEDGE DEBATE

• HINAYĀNA REALISTS MAHĀYĀNA

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• Vaibhāṣika Sautrāntika Yogācāra Mādhyamika external external objects cognition emptiness of dharmas inferred from ideas only all intrinsic nature

• (svabhāva) directly and causal effects perceived

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• SCHOOL LABELS MARK EPISTEMIC/ONTOLOGICAL POSITIONS, NOT FOUR PATHS TO MIX.

• BUDDHIST REALITY / KNOWLEDGE DEBATE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Buddhist school sequence progressively disputes whether external objects, cognitive representations or any intrinsic nature can count as ultimately real.

06

STAGE 06 VAIBHĀṢIKA AND SAUTRĀNTIKA

VAIBHĀṢIKA AND SAUTRĀNTIKA ISSUE VAIBHĀṢIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA EXTERNAL OBJECT REAL DHARMAS REAL MOMENTARY DHARMAS EXIST ONLY PRESENT CAUSAL MOMENT STRESSED COGNITION GRASPS SAUTRĀNTIKA ARGUMENT OBJECT-MOMENT IS GONE WHEN AWARENESS OCCURS THEREFORE COGNITION PRESENTS AN IMAGE, FROM WHICH EXTERNAL CAUSE REPRESENTATIVE REALISM MUST EXPLAIN CORRESPONDENCE.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

ISSUE VAIBHĀṢIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA external object real dharmas real momentary causes access direct perception inferred from mental image past/future

SAUTRĀNTIKA ARGUMENT: object-moment is gone when awareness occurs

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

SAUTRĀNTIKA ARGUMENT: object-moment is gone when awareness occurs

therefore cognition presents an image, from which external cause is inferred.

EVALUATION / TRAP

PRESSURE: representative realism must explain correspondence.

ISSUE VAIBHĀṢIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA external object real dharmas real momentary causes access direct perception inferred from mental image past/future

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

• ISSUE VAIBHĀṢIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA external object real dharmas real momentary causes access direct perception inferred from mental image past/future

• sarvāstivāda: dharmas exist only present causal moment stressed cognition grasps object represents object

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

• SAUTRĀNTIKA ARGUMENT: object-moment is gone when awareness occurs

• therefore cognition presents an image, from which external cause is inferred.

EVALUATION / TRAP

• PRESSURE: representative realism must explain correspondence.

• ISSUE VAIBHĀṢIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA external object real dharmas real momentary causes access direct perception inferred from mental image past/future

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Vaibhāṣika directly perceives external particulars, whereas Sautrāntika infers them from the representations they causally produce.

07

STAGE 07 YOGĀCĀRA AND MĀDHYAMIKA

YOGĀCĀRA AND MĀDHYAMIKA CONSCIOUSNESS-ONLY DOCTRINE (VIJÑĀNAVĀDA) MĀDHYAMIKA EMPTINESS (ŚŪNYATĀ) SUBJECT-OBJECT DUALITY IS CONSTRUCTED ALL THINGS LACK REPRESENTATION-ONLY DEPENDENT ARISING EMPTINESS STORE-CONSCIOUSNESS (ĀLAYA-VIJÑĀNA) STORES BIJA TENDENCIES TWO TRUTHS PARAMĀRTHA THREE NATURES PARIKALPITA, TETRALEMMA REJECTS IS IS-NOT PARATANTRA, PARINISPAṆNA BOTH

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• YOGĀCĀRA / CONSCIOUSNESS-ONLY DOCTRINE (vijñānavāda) MĀDHYAMIKA / EMPTINESS (śūnyatā) subject-object duality is constructed all things lack intrinsic nature

• (svabhāva) vijñapti-mātra: representation-only dependent arising = emptiness store-consciousness (ālaya-vijñāna) stores bija tendencies two truths: saṃvṛti / paramārtha three

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• natures: parikalpita, tetralemma rejects is / is-not paratantra, parinispāna both / neither as ultimate capture

• CONVERGENCE: dissolve reification

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• DIFFERENCE: Yogācāra privileges purified cognition, while Mādhyamika empties even consciousness and emptiness itself.

• YOGĀCĀRA / CONSCIOUSNESS-ONLY DOCTRINE (vijñānavāda) MĀDHYAMIKA / EMPTINESS (śūnyatā) subject-object duality is constructed all things lack intrinsic nature

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Momentariness (kṣanikavāda) (doctrine of momentariness) holds that whatever is causally efficient exists only momentarily, because a permanent entity could neither change its causal power nor produce genuinely successive effects.

08

STAGE 08 CRITIQUE AND PYQ ANSWER SPINE

CRITIQUE AND PYQ ANSWER SPINE FLUX CANNOT EXPLAIN CONTINUITY ANĀTMAN WEAKENS AGENCY EMPTINESS (ŚŪNYATĀ) IS NIHILISM CAUSAL SERIES DEPENDENT RESPONSIBILITY EMPTINESS DENIES SELF-NATURE, NOT FUNCTION ANSWER RAIL COMMON CORE

OBJECTIONS: flux cannot explain continuity

→

anātmān weakens agency

→

emptiness (śūnyatā) is nihilism

→

REPLIES: causal series

→

dependent responsibility

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

• OBJECTIONS: flux cannot explain continuity

• anātmān weakens agency

• emptiness (śūnyatā) is nihilism

• REPLIES: causal series

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

• dependent responsibility

• emptiness denies self-nature, not function

• ANSWER RAIL common core → twelve links → momentariness → five-skandha no-self

• action and moral consequence (karma)/memory reply → four-school fork → exact school comparison

REPLY / RESIDUAL

• objection/reply → qualified verdict

• CLOSE: Buddhism replaces substance with conditioned process

• Its schools progressively debate whether external dharmas, cognition, or any intrinsic nature can be retained.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The central realist criticism is that momentariness and no-self cannot explain recognition, memory and moral responsibility; the Buddhist reply relocates continuity from substance to causally connected causal continuum (saṁtāna) (continuum).

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT LAYER-PLACEMENT NOTE LAYER-PLACEMENT NOTE ALL LAYER 3 MATERIAL FROM THE LEGACY IT SHOULD REFINE A CORE ANSWER, NOT DISPLACE THE LAYER 3 - ADVANCED ADVANCED DERIVATION AND SCHOOL DIVERGENCE

IT DIAGNOSES THE STRUCTURE OF CONDITIONED BECOMING HERE AND THIS AVOIDS ETERNALISM BECAUSE NO UNCHANGED SELF GROUNDS THE THE DOCTRINE SUPPORTS DIFFERENT ONTOLOGICAL CONCLUSIONS.

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

• Layer-placement note

• Layer-placement note All Layer 3 material from the legacy complete session is retained here after practice.

• It should refine a core answer, not displace the printed syllabus.

• LAYER 3 - ADVANCED Advanced derivation and school divergence Dependent origination is not a search for the universe's first cause.

ADVANCED OBJECTION

• It diagnoses the structure of conditioned becoming here and now.

• This avoids eternalism because no unchanged self grounds the process, and avoids annihilationism because causal continuity remains.

• The doctrine supports different ontological conclusions.

• Mādhyamika argues that whatever depends on conditions lacks intrinsic nature (svabhāva) and is therefore empty.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

• Vaibhāṣika and Sautrāntika instead emphasise that causally functioning conditioned events are real.

• Their disagreement concerns ultimate status, not whether dependent arising occurs.

• The strongest challenge is regress: if every event is conditioned, what explains the chain as a whole?

• The Buddhist reply is therapeutic and structural rather than foundational—the task is to identify and cease the conditions

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.